



One might think that it is not very damaging, on the grounds that the actions subjects perform in the Libet experiments are in some ways different than paradigm examples of free action.

These are serious worries about Libet's argument. But let's set them aside and ask: if RP-onset is an unconscious decision, how damaging is that to our belief in freedom of the will?

Libet disagreed with this. His thought was that the decision to flex one's hand was meaningless, and that precisely for this reason it would be maximally free of any psychological constraints or external causes.

If RP-onset is an  
unconscious  
decision, does  
that limit our  
free will?



replies to  
Libet

A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the Libet experiments" is written in a white, sans-serif font, centered both horizontally and vertically.

the Libet  
experiments



is free will  
an important  
good?

This is not unreasonable — we do often use simple acts, like deciding to scratch one's nose, as an example of a free action.

in some ways different than paradigm examples of free action.

that the actions subjects perform in the Libet experiments are

One might think that it is not very damaging, the grounds

damaging is that our belief in freedom of the will?

These are serious worries about Libert's argument. But let's set

then aside and ask: if R<sub>P</sub>-onset is an unconscious decision, how

to flex one's hand was meaningless, and that precisely for this

reason it would be maximally free of any psychological

constraints or external causes.

Libert disagreed with this. His thought was that the decision

















replies to  
Libet

deciding to scratch one's nose, as an example of a free action.

This is not unreasonable — we do often use simple acts, like

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

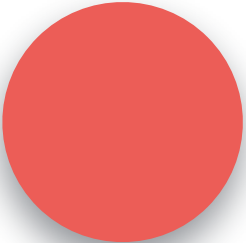
will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free



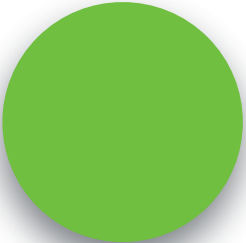




















If RP-onset is an  
unconscious  
decision, does  
that limit our  
free will?

deciding to scratch one's nose, as an example of a free action.

This is not unreasonable — we do often use simple acts, like